

food on the table. For every new child who shows up, you are taking a percentage of time and money away from the ones who already exist. This is why large families are a luxury of those with means. In families that suffer from severe financial burdens, having more kids does not lighten those burdens. On the contrary, *your children may inherit the burden*. That's right: instead of leaving your children an inheritance, you may actually leave them the burden of your debt.



The faster my businesses grew, the more time I spent away from home. I decided one day that no matter what happened with work, I would always spend my weekends with my kids and wife. Here I am enjoying some “bubbly” with Trevor and Savannah when they were young.

Families that are under deep economic stress encounter big problems when kids factor into the mix. Years into your marriage, you may find that cracks in the foundation of your partnership begin to show in new and ugly ways. If your relationship was founded on poor financial planning and mismanaged money—and if your decision to have a whole brood came from a purely emotional place, rather than being carefully thought out and prepared for—your kids may be the ones who pay the cost.

So how many kids can you afford to have? It's a simple math equation. According to Statistics Canada, it costs \$243,660 to raise a